

About the Authority Validation Standard (AVS)

Canonical Definition

Authority Validation Standard (AVS) defines the structural conditions under which authority remains verifiable, legitimate, recognizable, traceable, governable, accountable, reconstructable, and operationally valid throughout its lifecycle.

AVS governs authority validation.

The standard establishes the foundational conditions required to determine whether authority claims, authority assignments, delegated authority structures, authority rights, authority privileges, certifications, approvals, permissions, and governance mandates remain valid within operational environments.

What This Standard Is

AVS is a parent standard of the Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™).

It governs:

- authority validation
- authority verification
- authority legitimacy assessment
- authority recognition
- validation criteria governance
- validation traceability
- validation accountability
- authority-recognition governance

AVS establishes the governance layer responsible for determining whether authority remains valid before governance relies upon it.

What This Standard Is Not

AVS is not:

- an authority creation standard
- an authority delegation standard
- a responsibility standard
- a capability standard
- a control standard
- an oversight standard
- an accountability standard

AVS does not create authority.

AVS validates authority.

Why This Standard Exists

Authority alone does not guarantee legitimacy.

Delegated authority alone does not guarantee validity.

Organizations, institutions, regulators, certification bodies, governance systems, and intelligent systems frequently depend on authority claims.

Examples include:

- certifications
- licenses
- governance appointments
- supervisory authority
- delegated authority
- operational permissions
- AI-agent privileges
- execution rights

The challenge is not determining whether authority exists.

The challenge is determining whether authority remains valid.

AVS exists because authority validation has become a distinct governance space.

Core Insight

Authority should never be assumed. Authority must remain continuously verifiable.

Operational Architecture Space

AVS defines the operational architecture space for:

- authority validation governance
 - authority verification
 - authority legitimacy assessment
 - authority recognition
 - validation criteria governance
 - validation traceability
 - validation accountability
 - certification governance
 - permission validation
 - Human-AI authority validation
 - agent-authority validation
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This space exists because governance depends upon trusted authority.

AVS governs whether authority remains valid.

General Use Case 1 — Certification & Qualification Environment

Scenario

An organization relies upon certifications, qualifications, licenses, approvals, and governance permissions to perform operational activities.

Application

AVS governs verification of authority claims and validation of operational permissions.

Result

Governance gains visibility into whether authority remains legitimate and operationally valid.

General Use Case 2 — Intelligent Operational Environment

Scenario

An orchestration platform assigns authority and permissions to supervisory AI agents, execution agents, external tools, and autonomous systems.

Application

AVS governs validation of authority rights and operational privileges throughout the intelligent environment.

Result

Governance gains visibility into whether authority remains legitimate before operational actions are executed.

Architectural Position

Within AGA™, AVS serves as the fourth foundational governance layer.

The architecture progresses:

**Relationship → Authority → Authority Delegation → Authority
Validation → Responsibility → Capability → Control → Oversight →
Evidence → Accountability → Consequence**

AVS governs whether authority remains valid before governance

relies upon it.

Closing Definition

Authority validation is not the creation of authority. Authority validation is the governed process through which authority claims, permissions, certifications, privileges, approvals, and governance rights are verified, recognized, and maintained as operationally valid.

Authority may exist and authority may be delegated, but governance cannot rely upon authority that cannot be validated. If authority cannot be verified, governance integrity becomes unreliable.

Related Documents

[→ Authority Validation Standard - \(AVS\)](#)

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Canonical Source

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